



ClimFin

STAKEHOLDER MAPPING AND INSTITUTIONAL FRAMEWORK FOR STAKEHOLDER ENGAGEMENT

National Designated Authority – Ministry of Land,
Water and Environment, Eritrea

SUPPORT THE ENHANCEMENT OF THE INSTITUTIONAL,
HUMAN AND TECHNICAL CAPACITY OF ERITREA SYSTEM
FOR CLIMATE FINANCE

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Acronyms

Acronym	Term
AE	Accredited Entity
AfDB	African Development Bank
CSO	Civil Society Organization
DAE	Direct Access Entity
ESIA	Environmental and Social Impact Assessment
FAO	Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations
GCF	Green Climate Fund
GEDSI	Gender Equality, Disability, and Social Inclusion
HAC	Hamelmallo College of Agriculture
IFAD	International Fund for Agricultural Development
IFRC	International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies
MOU	Memorandum of Understanding
MSMEs	Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises
NARI	National Agricultural Research Institute
NCEW	National Confederation of Eritrean Workers
NDA	National Designated Authority
NGO	Non-Governmental Organization
NHERI	National Higher Education and Research Institute
NOP	No Objection Procedure
NRC	Norwegian Refugee Council
NUEW	National Union of Eritrean Women
NUEYS	National Union of Eritrean Youth and Students
PLWD	The Associations of Persons living with Disability
UNDP	United Nations Development Programme

1. Purpose and Objectives

One of the key principles of the Green Climate Fund (GCF) is [Country Ownership](#), which ensures that funding is provided and utilized through a country-driven approach. As set out in the GCF's [Governing Instrument](#), this country-driven approach is promoted and strengthened through inclusive engagement at the country level through effective consultations and involvement of relevant institutions and stakeholders. Establishing meaningful and participatory consultation mechanisms with a wide range of stakeholders is therefore a fundamental priority in all GCF country engagements.

The National Designated Authority (NDA) represents the national priorities and interests of the country to the GCF. One of the NDA's key roles is to convene and engage with international, regional, national, and local stakeholders related to accessing climate financing through the GCF. The NDA's role of convening stakeholders serves six purposes for GCF:

1. **Raising awareness of GCF** in the country to increase the general understanding of GCF's mandate, structure, and modalities among national stakeholders. This awareness raising can include information on opportunities for funding, GCF project cycles, and roles of various actors in GCF processes.
2. **Supporting the development of the GCF country programme** to identify and prioritize sectors for climate investment, project ideas, and strategic directions for GCF support in the country.
3. **Standardizing the No Objection Procedure (NOP) for GCF projects** to ensure stakeholders are able to give feedback and the NDA can build consensus in the design of projects proposed to the GCF. The process of developing the NOP ensures projects have broad national support and do not conflict with existing policies, strategies, and priorities in the country, allowing the NDA to sign the No Objection Letter in support of the project.
4. **Co-development or assessment of concept notes and funding proposals** for alignment with national plans, strategies, and priorities. This process engages technical and policy stakeholders in the review of concept notes and funding proposals and supports the NDA in its screening and decision making responsibilities.
5. **Annual monitoring and updates during GCF project implementation** to collect stakeholder feedback on the implementation of projects, monitor progress towards achieving climate objectives, and identify emerging needs. This helps support the NDA with adaptive learning and management.
6. **Regular communication on latest GCF developments** to keep stakeholders informed of changes to GCF policies, funding opportunities, and operational and/or procedural changes. This communication can include information sharing through newsletters, briefings, and NDA website updates.

By strengthening the NDA's role, Eritrea stands to benefit from enhanced transparency and accountability in climate finance decision-making, which will reinforce trust among stakeholders. It will also contribute to stronger climate governance through inclusive processes that align projects with national strategies and priorities. Additionally, increased mobilization of private sector actors can unlock additional investment flows to complement public financing. Finally,

sustained stakeholder engagement and knowledge sharing will build local institutional and technical capacities for project development, ensuring Eritrea is better positioned to access and effectively utilize GCF resources for climate-resilient development. All together, this will help Eritrea improve its response to climate change and more effectively and efficiently implement its priorities as described in the Nationally Determined Contribution (NDC) to the Paris Agreement, as well as other climate change strategies, policies, and plans.

2. Guiding Principles

Effective stakeholder engagement is essential to ensure the GCF-related processes are inclusive, equitable, and aligned with national climate and development goals, policies, and strategies. This engagement must be driven by clear principles that guide the NDA on how to consult, communicate, and collaborate with a range of stakeholders across all sectors. The following key principles will guide engagement processes:

- **Inclusive consultation processes:** engage all relevant stakeholders, including marginalized and vulnerable groups, through equitable and culturally inclusive methods.
- **Collaboration and consensus:** Promote joint problem solving and shared decision making by building consensus around national and local priorities
- **Transparent, objective, and accessible communication:** Provide clear, evidence-based, and timely information to all stakeholder groups, especially those with limited access to digital platforms
- **Strengthen partnerships and relationships:** Foster long-term trust between government entities, Civil Society Organizations (CSOs), private sector actors, academia, Gender Equality, Disability, and Social Inclusion (GEDSI) groups, and international partners
- **Empowering relationships and interactions:** Ensure that engagement enables all stakeholders to shape decisions and build capacity, especially at the local level
- **Regular and timely consultations:** Engage stakeholders at the earliest stages of policy or project development to ensure meaningful input and ownership
- **Build on existing platforms and mechanisms:** Leverage national consultation bodies, inter-ministerial groups, and established community structures to avoid duplication and build continuity

Attributes of successful stakeholder engagement include:

- **Accessibility:** Ensuring all stakeholders are able to participate regardless of geographic, physical, informational or other barriers so that they feel heard and able to provide meaningful information as needed
- **Accountability:** Be willing to set and accept clear responsibility for following up with stakeholders and ensuring that stakeholder input influences decision making
- **Appropriateness:** Tailor engagement methods to the context, audience, and purpose of each consultation
- **Balance:** Avoid dominance by any single stakeholder group and ensure diverse perspectives are heard
- **Fairness:** Engage with stakeholders such that they feel they are treated fairly, and their

- issues and concerns are afforded fair consideration
- **Inclusiveness:** Proactively anticipate, identify, and include all stakeholders, including women, youth, persons with disabilities, and other underserved communities
- **Sustainability:** Design mechanisms for engagement that endure beyond one-off events and foster long-term relationships, and which will contribute to the longevity of outcomes and impacts from implemented activities.
- **Financial Sustainability:** Clearly outline how stakeholder engagement activities will be financed and resourced, ensuring adequate funding and long-term maintenance of mechanisms that support continuous and meaningful participation.
- **Responsiveness:** Coherently respond in good time to all stakeholders
- **Transparency:** Share information openly and clarify how decisions are made and how stakeholder input is used

3. Stakeholder Mapping

3.1. Categories of Stakeholders

Category	Description of Role	Example Institutions	Influence Level
Accredited Entities (AEs)	AEs are responsible for the overall development and submission of project/programme proposals to the GCF. They are also responsible for the management, implementation, and monitoring of activities under the project/programme. AEs are expected to disburse funds with the same level of care as they would use in the administration of their own. There are two sub-categories of AEs: International Access Entities - entities that operate at the international level including United Nations agencies, multilateral development banks, public and private international organizations Direct Access Entities (DAE) - are sub-national, national or	International Access Entities¹ - UNDP, IFAD, AfDB, FAO DAEs: - Sahara and Sahel Observatory - The Eastern and Southern African Trade and Development Bank	High

¹ The full list of all GCF AEs is available at: <https://www.greenclimate.fund/about/partners/ae>

	regional organisations that need to be nominated by the NDA		
Government Ministries and Departments	Government ministries and departments lead national policy formulation for sectors relevant to climate finance access, climate finance planning, and GCF access coordination	- Ministry of Land, Water and Environment - Department of Environment - Division of Environment Management and Regulation - Ministry of National Development - Ministry of Local Government - Ministry of Finance and National Development - Ministry of Agriculture - Forestry and Wildlife Authority - Ministry of Marine Resources - Ministry of Health - Ministry of Transport and Communications - Ministry of Energy and Mines - Civil Aviation Department Meteorological Services Agency	High
Local Governments	Local governments at the regional, sub-regional, and district/village levels are responsible for planning	6 Zobas (Administrative Region)	Medium-High

	implementation, and community engagement. They play a key role in identifying local climate vulnerabilities and priorities, supporting grassroots involvement and interventions, and can serve as the implementing partners for local initiatives.	- Maekel (Central) - Anseba - Gash-Barka - Debub (Southern) - Northern Red Sea - Southern Red Sea 58 Sub-Zobas (Sub-Administrative regions) Kebabi (urban district, village, or areas)	
State Run Utilities	State Run Utilities contribute technical inputs to project design and support the implementation of projects.	- Eritrean Electricity Corporation	Medium
CSOs	CSOs represent local priorities and interests and promote accountability. They help to organize community outreach and gather grassroots, local, and sector specific feedback.	- Professional Associations such as the National Confederation of Eritrean Workers (NCEW), Water User Associations, and Farmers' Association - Community groups such as village representatives and community leaders - NGOs such as IFRC/ Red Cross Society of Eritrea (RCSE), the Norwegian Refugee Council	Medium

		(NRC)	
GEDSI groups	GEDSI groups ensure the inclusion of gender, youth, and vulnerable groups in climate change planning and implementation	National Union of Eritrean Women (NUEW) National Union of Eritrean Youth and Students (NUEYS) The Associations of Persons living with Disability (PLWD) Eritrean Women in Agribusiness Association	Medium
Academia	Academic institutions provide policy analysis, technical inputs, and data information for climate change related matters	- College of Agriculture - College of Business and Social Science - College of Health Sciences - College of Marine Sciences and Technology - Eritrea Institute of Technology - National Agricultural Research Institute (NARI) - National Higher Education and Research Institute (NHERI) - Hamelmalo College of Agriculture (HAC)	Medium

Private Sector actors	The local private sector plays a critical role in advancing climate action beyond co-financing. Private sector actors drive innovation by introducing new technologies, business models, and services that address climate challenges. They contribute to green job creation by developing climate-smart industries and employment opportunities in renewable energy, sustainable agriculture, and other low-carbon sectors. Additionally, they support value chain development by improving market access, strengthening supply chains, and integrating local producers and SMEs into climate-resilient and low-emission economies. Private sector engagement can range from co-implementation of adaptation and mitigation projects to mobilizing investments and, in some cases, applying for GCF accreditation.	- Local businesses - Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) - Cooperatives - Financial Institutions - Large enterprises	Medium-High
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3.2. Stakeholder Analysis Matrix

The following Stakeholder Analysis Matrix outlines the different purposes of engagement each stakeholder group should be consulted on in relation to GCF activities in Eritrea.

Purpose of Engagement	AEs	Government Ministries and Departments	Local Government	State Run Utilities	CSOs	GEDSI groups	Academia	Private Sector
Raising awareness of GCF		X	X	X	X	X	X	X
Supporting the development of the GCF country programme	X	X	X		X	X		
Standardizing the No Objection Procedure (NOP) for GCF projects		X						
Co-development or assessment of concept notes and funding proposals	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	X
Annual monitoring and updates during GCF project implementation	X	X	X	X	X	X		X
Regular communication on latest GCF developments		X	X		X	X		X

3.3. Stakeholder Map

GCF Stakeholders in Eritrea



4. Engagement Tools and Mechanisms

Effective stakeholder engagement relies on selecting communication tools and mechanisms that are accessible, inclusive, and tailored to the needs of different stakeholder groups. The NDA should employ a range of engagement tools to promote meaningful participation and ensure that the six core purposes of engagement outlined in this framework are successfully fulfilled.

The selection of tools should be informed by the characteristics of each stakeholder group, including their institutional roles, technical capacity, geographical reach, language needs, and access to technology. For example, local governments and community-based organizations may benefit from in-person workshops and townhall-style meetings conducted in local languages, while national ministries or accredited entities may prefer policy roundtables, technical working groups, or written consultations via email and shared online platforms. Youth and civil society actors might engage more effectively through interactive formats such as focus groups, storytelling sessions, or social media campaigns.

Where possible, the NDA should build on already existing formal and informal tools and mechanisms already used in national planning or development processes. Leveraging existing platforms helps reduce duplication, promotes continuity, and enhances national ownership. Additionally, stakeholder engagement should be culturally and linguistically appropriate. This includes using local languages when engaging with communities and grassroots organizations to ensure meaningful and effective communication, inclusive participation and informed decision making.

The following list provides tools and mechanisms for effective stakeholder engagement. This list is not exhaustive but represents commonly used and recommended approaches:

- **Formal Meetings:** Structured gatherings, often with set agendas, minutes, and decisions
- **Group discussions and forums:** Participatory events that bring together multiple stakeholders for open dialogue on specific themes and/or challenges. These discussions and forums can be multi-sectoral or stakeholder specific
- **Semi-structured interviews and surveys:** Collection of qualitative and quantitative information from individuals or small groups. These are especially useful during needs assessments or when seeking detailed, context-specific feedback from stakeholders
- **Varied presentation formats:** Adapted materials such as posters, infographics, videos, PowerPoint presentations, or storytelling formats tailored to different literacy and technical levels
- **Group activities:** Interactive exercises such as scenario planning, problem-tree analysis, role-playing, or theory of change development. Group activities promote hands-on learning and collaboration
- **Shared decision making:** Mechanisms that involve stakeholders in decision-making processes through building consensus or representative voting systems

- **Capacity building:** Training sessions, knowledge exchanges, or mentoring programs that empower stakeholders with the skills and tools needed to engage effectively and meaningfully in climate finance and GCF processes
- **Media outreach:** Use of radio, television, or advertising to raise awareness of national climate action. This is especially effective for reaching the general public and rural communities
- **Online Engagement:** Use of digital platforms, such as email, webinars, websites and social media, to communicate updates, receive feedback, or conduct virtual consultations
- **Permanent representation in and collaboration through national climate committees and decision making platforms:** The formal inclusion of stakeholder groups in national climate governance bodies to institutionalize their roles in planning and implementation processes
- **Formal partnerships:** Structure collaboration agreements, such as an Memorandum of Understanding (MOU), between the NDA and stakeholders

The following table outlines the proposed engagement mechanisms best suited to each identified category of stakeholder.

Stakeholder	Engagement Mechanisms
AEs	- Formal Meetings - Shared Decision Making - Group Discussions and Forums - Capacity Building - Online Engagement - Formal Partnerships
Government Ministries and Departments	- Formal Meetings - Shared Decision Making - Permanent Representation in Committees - Semi-Structured Interviews - Group Discussions and Forums - Varied Presentation Formats
Local Governments	- Group Discussions and Forums - Group Activities - Capacity Building - Varied presentation formats - Media Outreach - Semi-Structured Interviews
State Run Utilities	- Formal Meetings - Group Discussions and Forums - Capacity Building - Varied presentation formats: - Shared Decision Making - Online Engagement - Formal Partnerships

CSOs	- Group Discussions and Forums - Semi-Structured Interviews and Surveys - Group Activities - Capacity Building - Varied presentation formats - Online Engagement - Media Outreach - Permanent Representation in Committees
GEDSI groups	- Group Activities - Media Outreach - Capacity Building - Varied presentation formats - Semi-Structured Interviews - Inclusive Presentation Formats - Media Outreach - Permanent Representation in Committees
Academia	- Formal Meetings - Group Discussions and Forums - Semi-Structured Interviews - Capacity Building - Online Engagement - Permanent Representation in Committees - Formal Partnerships
Private Sector actors	- Formal Meetings - Group Discussions and Forums - Capacity Building - Varied presentation formats - Online Engagement - Permanent Representation in Committees - Formal Partnerships

5. Institutional Structure for Stakeholder Engagement

The NDA Team, housed within the Ministry of Land, Water and Environment, serves as the central coordination point for all GCF engagement in Eritrea. The core staff of the NDA GCF Team are responsible for operationalizing and executing NDA functions including leading stakeholder engagement across the strategic planning processes. To effectively fulfil its convening role, the NDA will:

- Act as the primary liaison between Eritrea and the GCF
- Facilitate stakeholder consultations during the development of strategic documents such as the Country Programme and No-objection procedures
- Lead capacity building efforts for sub-national and local actors to enhance access to GCF resources

- Coordinate the review of concept notes and funding proposals for alignment with national priorities
- Monitor project implementation progress
- Ensure transparency and inclusivity including active engagement of GEDSI groups

5.1. Proposed Structures to Support Effective Stakeholder Engagement

The following section proposes an institutional structure that enables the NDA to effectively serve as the central coordination point for coordination, engagement, and communication with key stakeholders across the six key purposes of the NDA's convening role with the GCF. With regards to GCF projects and coordinating the review of concept notes and funding proposals, the Eritrean National Environmental Assessment Procedures mandate that stakeholders must be consulted throughout project development processes, at three key stages: during the formulation of the Environmental and Social Impact Assessment (ESIA) terms of reference, throughout the ESIA process, and during the assessment of the ESIA report by the government. The NDA should build off of these existing mandates and processes when coordinating the engagement of stakeholder during GCF project development.

Proposed roles and responsibilities for stakeholder engagement in GCF processes:

- NDA Team:
 - Role: Day to day operations and engagement management
 - Responsibilities:
 - Coordinate and document stakeholder engagement
 - Maintain stakeholder database and engagement logs
 - Manage the calendar for consultations, validation events, and workshops
 - Communicate GCF updates and policy changes
 - Track the implementation of stakeholder feedback and concerns
 - Ensure GEDSI considerations are mainstreamed
- Establishment of the National Climate Change Steering Committee:
 - Role: Serve as formal advisory and oversight body for all GCF activities and engagement
 - Membership: Government ministries, regional governments (Zobas) and representatives from community groups
 - Responsibilities:
 - Endorse strategic decisions and GCF Country Programmes
 - Provide policy guidance and high-level coordination with national development priorities
 - Recommend sectors and thematic priorities for climate investment and project development
 - Support transparency, conflict resolution, and multistakeholder coordination

Proposed tools to be established by the NDA to support stakeholder engagement:

- Development of a Stakeholder Engagement Platform
 - Purpose: An inclusive and transparent consultation platform across all stakeholder categories
 - Structure/Format:
 - Virtual or in-person meetings, organized on a regular basis (quarterly or biannually)
 - Development of an NDA managed website to host materials and provide updates, and announcements
 - Participants: Representative of:
 - Government Ministries
 - Zobas and Sub-Zobas
 - CSOs
 - Academia and research institutions
 - Private Sector and MSMEs
 - GEDSI organizations
 - DAEs
 - Functions:
 - Share updates and receive feedback on GCF processes and proposals
 - Discuss climate change mitigation and adaptation gaps, opportunities and priorities for financing
 - Promote collaboration and build partnerships
 - Host trainings, dialogue, and information sessions
- Information Management System:
 - Purpose: Serve as a centralized, digital repository for managing and tracking all stakeholder engagement and feedback, GCF processes, and knowledge products
 - Structure and functions:
 - Stakeholder Database: Maintains profiles of stakeholders and focal points, consultation logs, and contact details
 - Document storage: Stores strategic documents, project documents, meeting minutes, feedback summaries, and training materials
 - Feedback tracker: logs stakeholder inputs and feedback across various documents

Stakeholder Engagement Process

1. Identification and Mapping
 - Maintain a living stakeholder map, based on the information provided in this document, including the roles, purpose of engagement, focal points and contact information
 - Identify and keep track of emerging sector-specific actors relevant to climate finance and GCF themes
2. Consultation planning
 - Develop annual and project-specific consultation schedules for engagement

- Prepare consultation material such as summaries, templates, and feedback forms
- Identify suitable engagement formats, tools and mechanisms
- 3. Engagement
 - Use diverse tools and mechanisms, as described in section 4, for each stakeholder
 - Translate materials and conduct engagement in local languages, where appropriate
 - Ensure and the inclusion of remote and rural communities, women, youth and persons with disabilities
- 4. Feedback integration
 - Keep a record of, analyze, and summarize stakeholder feedback
 - Document how feedback information the decision making process
 - Share revised drafts and justifications with stakeholders
- 5. Reporting and communication
 - Publish summary reports and updates on shared platforms such as an NDA website
 - Provide regular communication on new GCF updates, policies, and strategic guidance, via both online and offline distribution methods
 - Use the Information Management System to ensure transparency and track feedback follow-up